

Lab Experiment 14

Alpha-Beta Pruning Algorithm for Gaming

Aim

To write a Python program to implement the Alpha-Beta Pruning algorithm for a two-player game.

Objective

The objective of this experiment is to implement the Alpha-Beta Pruning algorithm for game playing. It aims to reduce unnecessary node evaluations and efficiently determine the optimal move.

Algorithm

1. Define the initial game state.
2. Generate all possible moves.
3. Build the game tree up to the terminal states.
4. Assign scores to the terminal states.
5. Initialize Alpha (α) and Beta (β) values.
6. Apply the Minimax algorithm with Alpha-Beta pruning.
7. Prune the remaining branches when $\alpha \geq \beta$.
8. Select the move with the best score for the maximizing player.
9. Display the optimal move and score.

Code

Alpha-Beta Pruning Algorithm for Tic Tac Toe

def winner(board):

lines = []

lines.extend(board)

lines.extend([
 [board[r][c] for r in range(3)]
 for c in range(3)
])

lines.append([board[i][i] for i in range(3)])
 lines.append([board[i][2 - i] for i in range(3)])

for line in lines:
 if line[0] != '' and all(x == line[0] for x in line):
 return line[0]

if all(board[r][c] != ''
 for r in range(3)
 for c in range(3)):
 return 'Draw'

return None

```
def alpha_beta(board, depth, alpha, beta, is_max):
```

```
    result = winner(board)
```

```
    if result == 'X':
```

```
        return 10 - depth
```

```
    if result == 'O':
```

```
        return depth - 10
```

```
    if result == 'Draw':
```

```
        return 0
```

```
    if is_max:
```

```
        best = float('-inf')
```

```
        for r in range(3):
```

```
            for c in range(3):
```

```
                if board[r][c] == '':
```

```
                    board[r][c] = 'X'
```

```
                    value = alpha_beta(
```

```
                        board, depth + 1,
```

```
                        alpha, beta, False
```

```
                    )
```

```
board[r][c] = ''
```

```
best = max(best, value)
```

```
alpha = max(alpha, best)
```

```
if alpha >= beta:
```

```
    break
```

```
if alpha >= beta:
```

```
    break
```

```
return best
```

```
else:
```

```
    best = float('inf')
```

```
for r in range(3):
```

```
    for c in range(3):
```

```
        if board[r][c] == '':
```

```
            board[r][c] = 'O'
```

```
            value = alpha_beta(
```

```
                board, depth + 1,
```

```
                alpha, beta, True
```

)

board[r][c] = ''

best = min(best, value)

beta = min(beta, best)

if alpha >= beta:

break

if alpha >= beta:

break

return best

def best_move(board):

best_value = float('-inf')

move = (-1, -1)

alpha = float('-inf')

beta = float('inf')

for r in range(3):

for c in range(3):

if board[r][c] == '':

```
board[r][c] = 'X'
```

```
move_value = alpha_beta(  
    board, 0, alpha, beta, False  
)
```

```
board[r][c] = ''
```

```
if move_value > best_value:  
    best_value = move_value  
    move = (r, c)
```

```
alpha = max(alpha, best_value)
```

```
return move, best_value
```

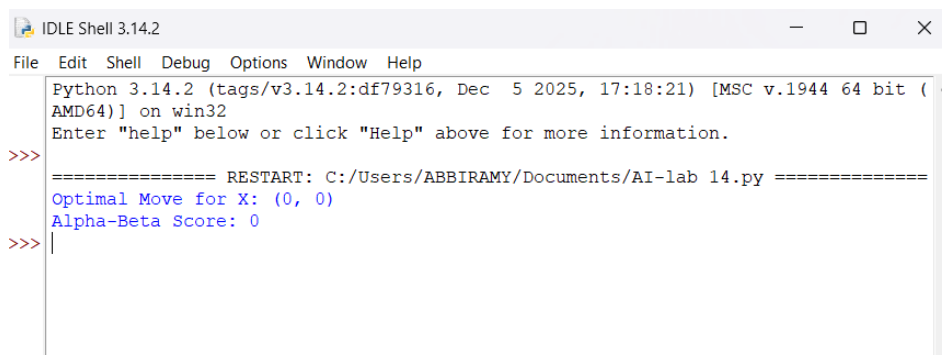
```
board = [[' ' for _ in range(3)] for _ in range(3)]
```

```
move, score = best_move(board)
```

```
print("Optimal Move for X:", move)
```

```
print("Alpha-Beta Score:", score)
```

Output



```
IDLE Shell 3.14.2
File Edit Shell Debug Options Window Help
Python 3.14.2 (tags/v3.14.2:df79316, Dec 5 2025, 17:18:21) [MSC v.1944 64 bit (
AMD64)] on win32
Enter "help" below or click "Help" above for more information.
>>>
===== RESTART: C:/Users/ABBIRAMY/Documents/AI-lab 14.py =====
Optimal Move for X: (0, 0)
Alpha-Beta Score: 0
>>> |
```

Result

The Python program successfully implemented the Alpha-Beta Pruning algorithm and determined the optimal move for the given game state.

Conclusion

Alpha-Beta Pruning improves the efficiency of the Minimax algorithm by eliminating branches that do not affect the final decision. It reduces the number of nodes evaluated while producing the same optimal result.